



Dual drug pill

A single pill with two drugs could transform blood pressure treatment
<https://digit.in/sep18-41-1>



Switch comic book app

An app called InkyPen will launch in November, and will give players the ability to read comics
<https://digit.in/sep18-41-2>

Xiaomi Mi A2

Worth the upgrade

Where phones in the upper mid-range segment are focusing on one aspect at a time (Honor Play, Huawei P20 Lite), the Mi A2 offers a smooth and reliable experience in almost all departments.

Design and build

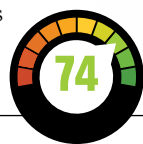
The Mi A2 bucks the trend of the glass-sandwich design to stick to a metal unibody design. The anodised finish is smooth but slippery, and is almost completely resistant to smudges. The display is Gorilla Glass 5. The buttons on the right side edge of the phone are a little wobbly. Another eyesore in the design is the camera bump. The slim form factor of the Mi A2 makes it easy to hold the phone and operate. The Mi A2 isn't going to make heads turn like the crop of Honor and Huawei phones does. But it absolutely functional and reliable and is bound to last longer than most glass-backed phones.

Display

The new display format allows the Mi A2 to provide more real estate without increasing the size of the phone by much. It has a similar 18:9 IPS LCD display introduced in the Redmi Note 5 Pro and stretches to 5.99-inches diagonally. The panel has a full HD resolution, meaning the pixel density is around 403ppi. It's sufficiently bright and vibrant, although it's not the most colour accurate one. The colour temperature is slightly on the cooler side and there's no way to tweak it. Most 16:9 videos appear letterboxed but YouTube videos do scale up to fit the larger screen. Games too take up the entire real estate and multi-tasking is much easier on this format.

Performance

The Mi A2 is an all-round performer. It doesn't focus on one single aspect and



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instead, tries to offer an overall smooth experience no matter whether you are gaming, streaming TV shows or browsing social media. The Mi A1 set the benchmark for mid-rangers higher and the Mi A2 takes it even further. Having the same hardware and the same

interface but with a lower price, the Mi A2 essentially eats into the goodwill earned by the Nokia 7 Plus which will have a difficult time convincing buyers to pay the extra premium for its sturdy and unique design.

Camera

The Mi A2, which brings pixel binning, relies on a dual camera setup with a 12MP primary and a 20MP secondary lens. The secondary sensor kicks in by default when there's less light, but you can manually switch to it in the pro-mode.

The camera itself is quite fast and snappy when there's ample light. Under low light, the camera takes a little longer to prepare for the next shot

which is understandable considering the pixel binning technology which takes time.

Overall, the camera on the Mi A2 is one of the biggest reasons to buy the phone. A lot many phones now offer a stock Android experience with commendable hardware, but few come close to the all-round consistency of the A2's camera.

Battery

The Xiaomi Mi A2 packs a 3010mAh battery which is a hair lesser than what the Mi A1 had. Yet, thanks to a similarly efficient processor and lightweight stock Android, the A2 easily manages to last a work day which typically begins around 10AM till 8PM in the night. On PCMark's Work 2.0 Battery Test, the Mi A2 lasted 5 hours 13 minutes, which is a reassuring score. Using a Quick Charge certified charger (not included) easily tops up the battery in around an hour, which otherwise takes a good 30 minutes more.

Bottomline

The Mi A2 has all the elements of success. A robust, functional design, a reliable display, lightweight UI augmented by a fast-performing chipset and a class-leading camera (especially in the low-light segment) makes the Xiaomi Mi A2 hard to pass over. It's definitely pricier than its predecessor but for good reason. The camera on the Mi A2 will be a definite hit with anyone even remotely into photography. The Mi A2 is also a more reasonable buy over the Nokia 7 Plus which has been ruling the upper mid-range segment in our review sheets for a while now, simply for the lesser price tag it comes with.

—Subhrojit Mallick

SPECIFICATIONS

DIMENSIONS: 158.7 x 75.4 x 7.3 mm | WEIGHT: 168 g | CHIPSET: Qualcomm Snapdragon 660 AIE | REAR CAMERA: 12MP, SONY IMX486; 20MP, SONY IMX376 | FRONT CAMERA: 20MP, SONY IMX376 | MEMORY: 4 GB+64 GB | WLAN: 802.11 a/b/g/n/ac | BLUETOOTH: 5.0 | BATTERY: 3010 mAh | DISPLAY: 5.99" FHD+ 18:9 Full screen display

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